

Ken Atkinson

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Multi-disciplined Leader with broad-based expertise driving global integrated teams to exceed program goals and corporate initiatives

Technical Summary

Education and Experience

Master of Engineering in Engineering Management, University of Colorado, 2009
MS Electrical Engineering, National Technological University, 2004
BS Mechanical Engineering, Colorado State University, 1994
17 years of Mechanical and Electrical engineering experience
20+ years Project and Program Manager experience

Certifications

Project Manager Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute
CMMC Certified Professional (CCP)
Agile Hybrid Project Pro, Project Management Institute
Six Sigma Master Black Belt, University of Colorado/ROI Alliance
Quality Systems for Product and Process Engineering, University of Colorado
Quality Management Systems (ISO 9001:2015 Requirements), British Standards Institute
Management Systems Auditing (ISO 19011:2018), British Standards Institute

Professional Summary

Recognized leader in improving Product Life Cycle results through combining Lean and Kaizen principles (e.g. Waste elimination, Andon, Gemba, etc.). Coach and mentor encouraging more effective project and program management skills and techniques.

Demonstrated successes in leading multi-disciplined, cross-functional teams in all phases of project lifecycles; from effective requirements gathering through sustainability with P&L Management of program budgets ranging from \$50K to over \$11M. Projects have delivered solutions to technically demanding customer challenges in electro-mechanical, aerospace, energy, process improvement, and Dept of Defense industries.

Work Experience and Accomplishments

Apr 2012 – Present: Senior Manager Business Optimization– Persistent Systems, LLC - Remote

Business Optimization – Recognized the need of rapidly growing company and formed the new 'Business Optimization' department. Manage and lead a team to create and update processes, tools, and capabilities to ensure business operations can support the rapid growth and increasing demands for the Defense Industrial Base. Lead IT project manager for various IT implementations (DCAA timekeeping, international travel, CMMC, Cyber Incident reporting, business operations dashboards)

Apr 2019 – Apr 2022: Sr. Program Manager – Persistent Systems, LLC – Fort Collins, CO

PMO Leader – Responsible to ensure team of Program Managers, Project Managers and their teams design, develop, deliver, and provide sustainment for all projects executed out of the Fort Collins office to support portfolio of military customers. Have improved team effectiveness and efficiency by implementing processes for stage gate, resource management, risk management, and stakeholder communication. Reorganized engineering and PMO in Fort Collins for better efficiency through a matrix organization.

Jan 2017 – Apr 2019: True North Special Assignment – PLC Improvement, Woodward, Inc – Fort Collins, CO

Special Assignment to Improve PLC Results Across the Entire Company – Hand selected to help lead corporate initiative to achieve lasting improvements in our Product Life Cycle (PLC) processes. Integration of Leader Standard Work principles (Andon, Gemba, Reflection, and Mentoring); custom Visual Management Systems, worldwide leadership training, and collaborative creation & documentation of new processes.

Oct 2015 – Jan 2017: Systems Program Manager/IPT Lead, Woodward, Inc – Fort Collins, CO

IPT Leader in PMO Responsible for Strategy and Performance of Project Management Team – Manager of Project Managers and Project Coordinators; accountable for team performance in meeting corporate goals and coordinating across the organization to improve overall results.

Sept 2013- Oct 2015: Engineering Program Manager, Woodward, Inc. – Fort Collins, CO

Leading New Product Introduction Teams to Exceed Customer Expectations – Providing clear direction and leadership for multiple cross functional NPI teams to deliver new control systems for industrial turbines. Effectively leading multiple simultaneous projects with budgets ranging from \$400K to over \$4M through the entire product life cycle with a keen focus on precise communication and risk mitigation.

2011-Aug 2013: Account Manager/PMO Execution Manager , M.C. Dean – Stuttgart, Germany

➤ **Expanding Customer Base & Improving PMO Execution** –Account Manager for maintaining and expanding all business performed for U.S. Africa Command. OCONUS PMO manager accountable for improving project execution by creating/enhancing and promoting processes and tools that standardize and encourage a disciplined approach to project management. Resource Manager of 6 Project Managers.

Dec 2009-Nov 2011: Project Manager, M.C. Dean – Stuttgart, Germany

➤ **Exceeded Customer Expectations While Achieving Exceptional Profit** – Directly responsible for over \$11M design and installation of complex C4I solutions for US Military operational requirements. Directly responsible for schedule performance, budget, scope, and leading a multi-disciplined / geographically diverse team of over 20 engineers, technicians, and sub-contractors. Customers delighted with quality of work delivered; projects came in on or under schedule and all projects yielded at least 22% gross profit .

2004- Dec 2009: Senior Electrical Engineer/Project Manager, Ball Aerospace & Technologies Corp.

➤ **Lead 'Rescue Mission' to Recover Project in Jeopardy** – Proposed, organized, and lead the takeover and turn-around of a critical subsystem that jeopardizing the entire spacecraft schedule. After capturing this project, applying aggressive project management, acquiring an excellent team, and executing efficiently, we were able to deliver this subsystem ahead of schedule. Due to the exceptional performance I was able to arrange special bonuses for the team.

➤ **Regained Lost Customers** – Due to poor performance and communication customers were selecting other vendors. I was asked to step in and improve the project management and delivery. Results including capturing all lost clients and adding 2 new customers.

➤ **Maintained Excellent EVMS indices as Project Manager on Multiple Concurrent Programs** – Delivered on schedule (SPI = 1) with CPI's varying from .75 (due to vague SOW) to .95 on three different concurrent satellites/projects. Total responsible budget for all three programs approx \$3.2M. Created tools to gather essential metrics for project control and reporting.

➤ **Integrated Product Team Lead for \$2.2M Dept. of Defense Satellite Sub-System** – Coordinated cross-functionally to develop initial electrical harness requirements. From requirements created multiple System Engineering Reports, error analysis, risk analysis, Electrical and Mechanical Interface Control Documents, Product Functional Specifications, and Statements of Work for subcontracts worth \$5M to \$30M. Designed entire spacecraft cable harness, and created project plan spanning 2.5 years. Responsible for planning and managing \$2.2M budget, spending forecast, and resource allocation. Set up sub-contract cable fabrication to reduce project cost and maintain aggressive schedule.

➤ **Enhancing Market Opportunity for Ball Aerospace**– Initiated and submitted a proposal for Intra-Spacecraft Wireless Communications and was awarded \$23K to develop a Market Study and Technology Assessment. Worked with University of Colorado to explore market opportunities.

2001-2004: NPI Engineer, Agilent Technologies

➤ **Lowered Product Cost 22%** - Managed the transfer and supply chain setup of an electro-mechanical fixture to Malaysia manufacturing team. Lower cost enabled product to be more competitive in Asia with a gross profit margin exceeding 52%.

➤ **Increased Customer Shipments During New ERP Transition** –PLC/NPI Business Process Lead for new corporate ERP transition: Led coordination effort with more than 6 teams in 4 countries to address each team's unique requirements. Redesigned business processes to most effectively use new ERP system to meet these needs. Provided customized training for each team. *Result: shipment cutover completed 25 days ahead of schedule.*

➤ **Improved Division Efficiency** – Proactively provided world-wide focused training classes for managers and engineers to enable them to most effectively use the new Oracle / MatrixOne ERP system. *Result: Those trained and mentored under this program were the quickest to adopt and master the new system.*

1998-2001: Mechanical Design Engineer, Agilent Technologies.

{Note: Hewlett-Packard moved me to Colorado for this position, Agilent Technologies was spun off from Hewlett Packard in 1999}

1997-1998: Manufacturing Development Engineer, Hewlett-Packard

1994-1997: Lead Engineer and Supervisor, Semborg Corporation, Blockbuster Entertainment.

Relevant Skills and Experience

- **Strategic Leadership:** Change Management, P&L Management, Cross Functional Program delivery
- **Operational Excellence:** Six Sigma Master Black Belt, Lean/Kaizen, ISO 9001/19011
- **Technical Governance:** CMMC/Cybersecurity, ERP Implementation, DCAA Policy and Procedure development
- **Project Management Tools:** MS Project, Earned Value Management System (EVMS)
- **Enterprise Resource Planning Tools:** Oracle, MatrixOne, Agile
- **Mechanical Design Tool Experience:** SolidDesigner, SolidWorks, ME10, and AutoCAD
- **IT Skills:** Power BI, Certified Cybersecurity Model Certification lead, SharePoint
- **Programming Experience:** C, Visual C++, Visual Basic, PLC's, and Assembly
- **Analytical Tool Experience:** MATLAB, Finite Element Analysis, GD&T, Linear Programming, SPSS, DOE++